



Las Palmas Grand Residents Association

Observer

February 2026

Volume 6 Edition 1

Who Are We?

The Las Palmas Grand Residents Association (LPGRA) is non-profit organization formed for all residents of Las Palmas Grand (LPG). All lease holders are automatically members. **There are NO dues to pay!**

The purpose of LPGRA is to provide homeowners with a voice to LPG Management. The LPGRA Board meets with Management monthly and serves as a liaison between residents and managers regarding concerns and interpretation of established rules, policies, and procedures. LPGRA also works to enhance rapport and camaraderie among its members through fun events. Money raised through recycling and other fund-raising activities is used for annual donations to other non-profit organizations and minor operational expenses.

Come join us! We meet the first Thursday of every month at 9:30 am in the clubhouse, and we'd love to see you there. Our meetings are informational, and our purpose is to enhance the quality of life within LPG. Feel free to bring any questions and concerns you may have.

See you at our next meeting!

MEET YOUR 2026 BOARD MEMBERS:



Donna Provost
President



Peggy Marcone
1st Vice-President



Ted Johnston
2nd Vice-President



LuAnn Cameron
Secretary



Cheryl Jorban
Treasurer

2026 LPGRA Meeting Dates

9:30 AM - Clubhouse Card Rooms

JANUARY 8, 2026

MARCH 5, 2026

MAY 7, 2026

JULY 2, 2026

SEPTEMBER 3, 2026

NOVEMBER 5, 2026

FEBRUARY 5, 2026

APRIL 2, 2026

JUNE 4, 2026

AUGUST 6, 2026

OCTOBER 1, 2026

DECEMBER 3, 2026

LPGRA 2025 END OF YEAR FINANCIAL REPORT



AAMHO NEWS

2025 INCOME:

Recycle:.....	2,238.20
This amount includes \$51.70 collected on 12/31/2024, but not deposited until 1/2/2025. The total amount of recycling collected for 2025 is \$2,186.50.	
Bag Sales.....	1,500.00
Net income from bag sales is \$574.86: \$1500.00 - \$925.14 (cost))	
50/50.....	527.00
This amount includes \$96.00 donated back to LPGRA by the winners.	
Total Income:	\$4,265.20

2025 EXPENSES:

Annual donations:	1,980.00
\$330.00 donated to 6 charitable organizations: House of Refuge, 100 Club of Arizona, P.A.W.S.S, Sunshine Acres Children's Home, Arizona Farm Bureau, and Family Promise.	
Promotional Items.....	925.14
75 blue bags: \$489.92; 75 red bags: \$435.22	
Webmaster.....	500.00
Donuts.....	297.64
(June, July, August, September, November)	
Chili Cook-off Supplies.....	114.65
Admin Costs.....	32.79
Door Prizes.....	220.00
Total Expenses:.....	\$4,070.22

NET INCOME FOR 2025: \$194.98

NOTEWORTHY ACHIEVEMENTS FOR 2025:

- **Bob Williams and his recycling team collected an amazing \$2,186.50 for 2025 – the highest annual amount since the recycling program began.**
- **LPGRA earned the highest annual gross income of \$4,265.20 since the inception of the LPGRA.**
- **We donated the highest amount ever of \$1,980.00 to 6 well-deserving non-profit organizations @ \$330.00 each.**

AAMHO (Arizona Association of Manufactured Home Owners) is a registered 501(c)4 non-profit organization representing YOU as an owner of a manufactured home here in Las Palmas Grand. You live in a community that is governed by the AZ Mobile Home Parks Residential Landlord and Tenant Act (LTA). AAMHO is the organization that introduces and supports legislation in Arizona to protect and strengthen your rights, opposes legislation unfavorable to community residents, and monitors all legislative actions for possible unintended consequences.

Recently, two AAMHO-supported bills passed out of committee in Arizona's Legislature: HB 2199 and Wildfire's HB 2459. HB 2199 expands the manager certification requirement to apply to ALL park managers and not just those in manufactured home parks. HB 2459 is Wildfire's bill about utility charges, and says that landlords cannot charge residents more than what the parks are actually paying, plus an admin fee of \$8 or less.

For more information on what AAMHO does for you, please consider joining AAMHO. You can go to their website, aamho.org, to apply for membership, which is only \$35.00 for 1 year, \$60 for two years, or \$150.00 for 5 years.

Recycle Program



Our recycling program, headed by Bob Williams and his volunteer helpers, is AWESOME!! This past year LPGRA earned **\$2,186.50** from recycling!

Reminder: The LPGRA recycling program takes **ONLY** aluminum beverage cans and clear plastic beverage bottles to J&C Recycling:



Please do not place any other materials (i.e. glass or non-clear plastic containers) in the blue barrels, which are located in the green waste area on Juniper Hills.

Also, we get **MORE** money per pound if you smash your aluminum cans and water bottles prior to placing into the blue bins:



Thank you to all who participate in our recycling program. And a **BIG THANKS** to Bob Williams and his crew.



HOME SAFETY

DID YOU KNOW?

The Mesa Fire and Medical Department's Home Safety Education (HSE) Program is a free, in-home service for City of Mesa residents designed to reduce risks of falls and fires.

Key Components of the HSE Program:

- **In-Home Visits:** Volunteers visit homes to provide personalized safety suggestions.
- **Fall Prevention:** Assessments to help prevent accidents, particularly for seniors.
- **Fire Safety:** Education on creating escape plans and maintaining safety equipment.
- **Safety Equipment:** Assistance with smoke alarm checks and the installation of grab bars.
- **Target Audience:** Available to all City of Mesa residents.

For more information, or to set up an appointment, residents can contact the Mesa Fire and Medical Department by telephone: (480) 644-2101, or by email: FDHomeSafety@mesaaz.gov.

The program is part of the community outreach efforts to promote a safer living environment.

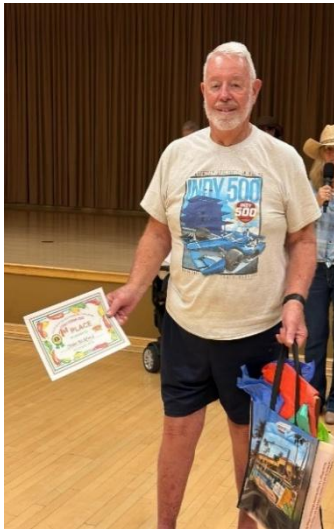


The LPGRA Chili Cook-off held on January 20, 2026, in the ballroom was a huge success and fun time for all, with 16 chili cooks competing for a prize, and all the attendees voting for their choice of best chili. The western-

themed event was filled with food, entertainment, and a chance to enjoy a free chili cook-off party and even win a cash prize from the 50/50 drawing. LPGRA Board member Ted Johnston served as master of ceremonies, while entertainment was provided by Verna Lindvall on the keyboard, dancing by the LPGRA line dancers led by Becky Riveras, and DJs Bill and Tom.

Special thanks to Jeff and Vicky Wilde, and their kitchen volunteers Sherri Davis and Sheila Gambino, who cooked and served free chili and cornbread to all those attending. Also thanks to Mark Meiners, Francene Barbro-Meiners and Sharon Hauser for selling the 50/50 tickets.

Here are the big winners of the day:



BEST CHILI

Mike Bickford won the 1st place prize for making the overall best chili as voted by the attendees.

Congratulations, Mike!



1ST RUNNER-UP

Mike Shelton won the 2nd place prize for best chili as voted by the attendees.

Congratulations, Mike!



2nd RUNNER-UP

Jamie Rumley won the 3rd place prize for best chili as voted by the attendees.

Congratulations, Jamie!



50/50 WINNER

A whopping \$308.00 was collected for the 50/50 raffle, and Barb Thomas was awarded half of it.

Congratulations, Barb!

MORE PICTURES FROM THE CHILI COOK-OFF





LPGRA donated \$330.00 each to 6 non-profit organizations in 2025. Here are letters of appreciation from 3 of them:

From Family Promise:

Thank you for your generous gift to Family Promise – Greater Phoenix. Your support transforms lives by providing families with not just shelter, but hope and a path forward...

Let me share how your gift creates lasting change. Lia, one of our recent graduates, arrived at our doors at 4 a.m. with her children, having driven from Las Vegas with nothing but what fit in her car. Through determination and support of our community, Lia transformed her life. Today, she's pursuing her bachelor's degree in clinical psychology and plans to continue to a master's program—a testament to the power of community support and personal resilience....

Thank you for being part of our mission to end family homelessness, one family at a time.

With gratitude,

(signed) Ted Taylor, Chief Executive Officer

From Sunshine Acres Children's Home:

Thank you so much for your generous gift of \$330.00 during this wonderful Christmas season that is so special for our children. Our children make a wish list, and our friends are so generous that they usually get everything on their list...

So many of our children have told me they never had a good Christmas until they came to Sunshine Acres Children's Home. We just took in three children that had been living in their car. One of the boys said, "You mean I can have food anytime I want?" and the six-year-old girl said how amazing this place is and how she now gets to live in a home...

It brings us so much joy to know that we have friends like you who continue to believe in and strengthen our mission. Thank you again for your gift that is changing lives.

(signed) Carol Whitworth, President CEO

From House of Refuge:

Thank you for your very generous gift to House of Refuge. What you've done is nothing short of extraordinary. Your gift is more than a donation—it's an act of profound faith in the human spirit. Because of you, families who once faced the uncertainty of homelessness are now standing on the firm ground of stability, dignity, and hope. Mothers and fathers can focus on finding good jobs. Parents can return to school. Children can sleep soundly at night, knowing they are safe. Your generosity is the steady hand that helps them rebuild.

This is the impact of your giving. You're not simply providing a roof—you're offering the tools, support, and confidence families need to create lasting change. Your gift is a powerful statement: every family matters.

(signed) Jacqueline Cruz, Chief Development Officer

Happy Valentine's Day!



Valentine's Day and sweet treats go hand in hand. Celebrate by making the following (very easy) Valentine's Day cookies:

Ingredients

- ½ pound butter, softened
- 2 ½ cups sifted all-purpose flour
- 1 cup sifted confectioners' sugar
- 1 tablespoon milk
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract

Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 325 degrees F (170 degrees C). Grease baking sheets or line with parchment paper.
2. Cream butter in a large bowl with a mixer until light. Add flour, confectioners' sugar, milk, and vanilla; mix until well combined and velvety.
3. Roll 1/2 of the dough to about 1/4-inch thickness, using the smallest amount of flour possible. Cut out dough with heart-shaped cookie cutter, and place on the prepared baking sheets. Roll and cut out remaining dough.
4. Bake in the preheated oven for 12 minutes. Cookies will be almost white.
5. When cooled, decorate with pink icing and candy sprinkles.



The Case of the Missing Easter Bunny

It was Easter Sunday, and Larry, 82, was in high spirits, having spent the day at his "50's Diner" themed family gathering with his wife, children, and grandchildren.

Later in the afternoon, his daughter brought him back to his cozy home in LPG to relax. "Dad," she said, "I put your special chocolate Easter bunny on the coffee table. Don't let anyone steal it!"

Larry nodded sagely. "I'll watch it like a hawk," he promised.

An hour later, his daughter returned to find Larry looking distressed, searching under the sofa cushions.

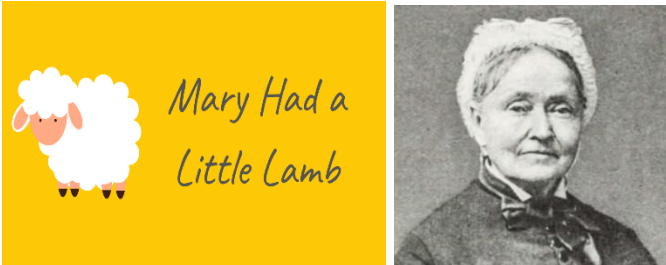
"What's wrong, Dad?" his daughter asked.

"It's gone!" Larry exclaimed. "My chocolate bunny! I only turned my head for a minute to look at an old photo, and *poof*—it's disappeared! Must be ghosts."

His daughter chuckled, walked over to the armchair where Larry had been sitting, and lifted the daily newspaper from his chair. There sat the chocolate bunny, perfectly safe, which Larry had forgotten he had placed there for safekeeping, and then sat on.

"Oh!" Larry laughed, blushing slightly. "Well, I guess I was just keeping it warm for the Easter Bunny!"

The following story appeared in a shareable FaceBook post. I thought it was worth sharing with you in our springtime Observer:



Did you know that the nursery rhyme you sang as a child was based on a real 9-year-old girl who saved a dying lamb and accidentally made history?

"Mary had a little lamb, little lamb, little lamb..." You probably sang it in kindergarten. Maybe you sang it to your own children. But did you know Mary was real? And so was her lamb?

This is the true story behind one of the most famous nursery rhymes in history.

In March 1815, on a cold morning in Sterling, Massachusetts, nine-year-old Mary Sawyer was helping her father with chores in the barn. They discovered that one of their ewes had given birth to twin lambs overnight—but something was wrong. One lamb was healthy and nursing. The other had been rejected by its mother and was lying in the straw, barely breathing, too weak to even stand. Without its mother's care and milk, the tiny creature was dying of cold and hunger. Mary's heart broke at the sight.

"Can I take it inside?" she begged her father. Her father shook his head. "No, Mary. It's

almost dead anyway. Even if we try, it probably won't survive."

But Mary couldn't bear to watch the lamb die. She pleaded with her father until he finally relented—though he made it clear he thought it was hopeless. When they returned to the house, Mary's mother agreed to let her try. Mary wrapped the freezing lamb in an old garment and held it close to the fireplace, cradling it in her arms through the long night. She didn't know if it would make it to morning. The lamb was so weak it couldn't even swallow at first. But Mary refused to give up.

By morning, against all odds, the lamb was standing. Over the next few days, with Mary's constant care—feeding it milk, keeping it warm, nursing it back to strength—the little creature recovered completely.

And then something magical happened. The lamb, whom Mary had saved from death, became utterly devoted to her. It recognized her voice. It came running when she called. And everywhere that Mary went, the lamb truly was "sure to go."

One morning before school, Mary called out to her lamb as she was leaving. The lamb came trotting over immediately. Mary's mischievous older brother, Nat, grinned and said, "Let's take the lamb to school with us!"

Mary hesitated—she knew it was against the rules—but the idea was too tempting. She agreed. She tried to smuggle the lamb into the one-room Redstone School by hiding it in

a basket under her desk, hoping it would stay quiet.

For a while, her plan worked. The lamb nestled silently beneath her seat as the lesson began. Then Mary was called to the front of the classroom to recite her lesson. As she stood and began to read aloud, the lamb suddenly bleated loudly and leaped out from under her desk, following Mary to the front of the room. The classroom erupted.

The students burst into laughter at the sight of a fluffy white lamb wandering the aisles, bleating and looking for Mary. Even the teacher, Polly Kimball, "laughed outright"—though she gently told Mary that the lamb would have to go home.

Mary, embarrassed but smiling, led her lamb outside to wait in a shed until school ended. She thought that would be the end of it—a funny story to tell at dinner.

But someone else was watching. Among the visitors at the school that day was a young man named John Roulstone, a college-bound student staying with his uncle, the local minister. He was charmed by the sight of Mary's devoted lamb following her into school.

The next day, John rode his horse across the fields to the little schoolhouse and handed Mary a slip of paper. On it, he'd written three simple stanzas:

"Mary had a little lamb,
Its fleece was white as snow,
And everywhere that Mary went,

The lamb was sure to go.

It followed her to school one day,

That was against the rule.

It made the children laugh and play,

To see a lamb at school..."

Mary treasured that piece of paper. She kept it for years, along with the memory of the lamb she'd saved. The lamb lived to be four years old, bearing three lambs of her own before she was accidentally killed by a cow in the barn.

Mary's mother saved some of the lamb's wool and knitted stockings for Mary, which she treasured for the rest of her life.

But the story doesn't end there. In 1830, a well-known writer and editor named Sarah Josepha Hale published a collection called *Poems for Our Children*. Among them was a poem called "Mary's Lamb"—the same verses John Roulstone had written, plus three additional stanzas with a moral lesson about kindness to animals.

The poem spread like wildfire. It was reprinted in schoolbooks across America. Children everywhere began singing it. By the 1850s, it was one of the most famous children's poems in the country.

But here's where it gets even more remarkable: In 1877, nearly sixty years after Mary saved that lamb, inventor Thomas Edison was testing his brand-new phonograph—the first machine ever capable of recording and playing back sound. He

needed something to recite to test if it worked. He chose "Mary Had a Little Lamb."

Edison's voice reciting those words became the first audio recording in human history. The poem that began with a nine-year-old girl's compassion became the first sound ever captured by technology.

As for Mary herself, she lived a long, quiet life. She married, raised a family, and rarely talked about the famous poem until she was an elderly woman.

In 1876, at age 70, Mary finally came forward to share her story publicly when she donated the stockings her mother had made from her lamb's wool to help raise money to save Boston's Old South Meeting House. She sold autographed cards tied with yarn from those stockings, telling the world: "I am the Mary. This is my lamb's wool."

People were astonished. The woman behind the nursery rhyme was real—and she was still alive. Mary Sawyer died in 1889 at age

83. Today, a statue of her little lamb stands in Sterling, Massachusetts, commemorating the day a nine-year-old girl's compassion for a dying animal created one of the most enduring stories in children's literature.

The lesson of "Mary Had a Little Lamb" isn't just about a pet following its owner. It's about what happened before that—about a little girl who refused to let a helpless creature die, who fought for its life when everyone else had given up, who showed that kindness and determination can create miracles. Mary saved her lamb. And in return, that lamb gave her immortality.

The next time you hear someone (maybe your grandchild?) sing "Mary had a little lamb," remember: it wasn't just a nursery rhyme. It was a true story about a real girl who taught us that compassion matters, that small acts of kindness ripple through time, and that sometimes the gentlest hearts change the world.

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